

IN Credit: Innovation

This credit applies to

- BD+C: New Construction (1–5 points)
- BD+C: Core and Shell (1–5 points)
- BD+C: Schools (1–5 points)
- BD+C: Retail (1–5 points)
- BD+C: Data Centers (1–5 points)
- BD+C: Warehouses and Distribution Centers (1–5 points)
- BD+C: Hospitality (1–5 points)
- BD+C: Healthcare (1–5 points)

INTENT

To encourage projects to achieve exceptional or innovative performance to benefit human and environmental health and equity. To foster LEED expertise throughout building design, construction, and operation and collaboration toward project priorities.

REQUIREMENTS

NC, CS, SCHOOLS, RETAIL, DATA CENTERS, WAREHOUSES & DISTRIBUTION CENTERS, HOSPITALITY, HEALTHCARE

To achieve all five innovation points, a project team must achieve at least one pilot credit, at least one innovation credit and no more than two exemplary performance credits.

Option 1. Innovation (1 point)

Achieve significant, measurable environmental performance using a strategy not addressed in the LEED green building rating system.

Identify the following:

- the intent of the proposed innovation credit;
- proposed requirements for compliance;
- proposed submittals to demonstrate compliance; and
- the design approach or strategies used to meet the requirements.

Examples of innovation may be found in the LEED Innovation Catalog.

AND/OR

Option 2. Pilot (1 point)

Achieve one pilot credit from USGBC's LEED Pilot Credit Library.

AND/OR

Option 3. Additional Strategies

- **Innovation (1–3 points)**
Defined in Option 1 above.
- **Pilot (1–3 points)**
Meet the requirements of Option 2.
- **Exemplary Performance (1–2 points)**

Achieve exemplary performance in an existing LEED v4 prerequisite or credit that allows exemplary performance, as specified in the LEED Reference Guide, v4 edition. An exemplary performance point is typically earned for achieving double the credit requirements or the next incremental percentage threshold.

GUIDANCE

There are no substantive changes to the credit requirements; refer to the LEED v4 reference guide, with the following additions:

Step-by-Step Guidance

Follow steps in the LEED v4 reference guide, with the following additions:

Step 2. Develop Innovation Point Strategy

If projects pursue a pilot ACP, they are exempted from the requirement to pursue at least one pilot credit. To achieve all five points in the Innovation credit under this approach, projects may select one of the following point combinations:

- 4 innovation and 1 exemplary performance
- 3 innovation and 2 exemplary performance

Further Explanation

Connection to Ongoing Performance

LEED O+M IN credit Innovation: Many innovation strategies are also available in the LEED O+M v4.1 credit Innovation. Other innovation strategies focus on innovative performance tracking or operations practices that can be initiated during design and construction and set up a project for success in achieving higher performance scores.